Contables e incontables: some, any, much, many

Apuntes · Tema 5 · Inglés · 2º ESO

Código de colores: definición fórmula o idea clave ojo / error típico ejemplo

1. Sustantivos contables e incontables

Definición: contable e incontable

Contables: se pueden contar y tienen plural (*an apple, two apples, a book, three books*).

Incontables: no se cuentan, no tienen plural ni llevan *a/an* (*water, milk, bread, money, information, music, homework, advice*).

Ojo

Algunos incontables en inglés son contables en español: *information, advice, homework, furniture, news*. Se dice *some information* (no *informations*). Para contarlos: *a piece of information, a glass of water, a loaf of bread, a bottle of milk.*

2. A / an, some, any

	Contables	Incontables
Afirmativa	**a / an** (singular), **some** (plural): *There are some eggs.*	**some**: *There is some milk.*
Negativa	**any**: *There aren't any eggs.*	**any**: *There isn't any milk.*
Pregunta	**any**: *Are there any eggs?*	**any**: *Is there any milk?*

Ojo

En ofrecimientos y peticiones se usa *some* aunque sea una pregunta: *Would you like **some** tea? Can I have **some** water, please?*

3. Much, many, a lot of, a few, a little

	Contables	Incontables	Ejemplo
mucho/s (afirmativa)	a lot of / lots of		*I have a lot of friends / a lot of time.*
mucho/s (neg. y pregunta)	many	much	*I don't have much time. Have you got many friends?*
pocos / poco (algunos)	**a few**	**a little**	*a few biscuits, a little sugar*
¿cuánto/s?	How many…?	How much…?	*How many brothers have you got? How much money do you need?*

Clave: truco

many y a few con lo que se puede **contar**; much y a little con lo que **no**. *A lot of* sirve para los dos.

Ejemplo: en la cocina

We need some eggs and a little flour. There isn't any butter and there aren't many tomatoes. How much sugar do we need? Just a few spoons.